

MAYEES-AGNIHOTRI



State of Repair

LUCKNOW The hand that rocks the state has come down heavily once again on a minister for his alleged links to the murder of a police constable. Chief Minister Mayawati has sacked Minister of State for Fisheries Jamuna Prasad Nishad who has been arrested. He had allegedly led a mob against a police station in Maharajganj district.

In the attack, the mob snatched a rifle from a

policeman and opened fire, killing a constable on the spot. The murder triggered off resentment among the constabulary against senior police officers who did not visit the scene. Their juniors suspected that the officers had toned down the investigation to save the minister, allegedly at the behest of senior officials.

Mayawati, sensing that the incident could fireball into an ugly situation for her government, ordered

SACKED: Nishad the registration of a murder case against the minister and his supporters. Mayawati also granted a compensation of Rs 16 lakh to the deceased's family.

Nishad's sacking is not the first of its kind in the Mayawati Government. She has made prosecuting corrupt ministers something of a trademark. She had earlier sacked Anandsen Yadav, an MLA who had been elevated to the rank of minister. Yadav had figured prominently in the murder of a young girl in his home district Faizabad. She had also ensured the arrest of BSP MP Rama Kant Yadav in a land-grabbing case.

By winning the May 2007 polls with a clear mandate, Mayawati is not burdened by the compulsions of a coalition government where she has to please all. Running a one-woman show, the chief minister is slowly but surely ensuring that the BSP comes across as a clean party while consolidating her image as the "iron lady" of Uttar Pradesh. *by Subhash Mishra*

SIGNPOSTS

DIED: Princess **Karthika Tirunal Lakshmi Bai**, 92. She was the senior-most member of the Travancore royal family and the sister of the last princely ruler of Travancore, Sree Chithira Tirunal Balarama Varma.



DIED: **Alladi Ramakrishnan**, 85, founder and director of the Institute of Mathematical

Sciences (MATSCIENCE), Chennai. He died in Florida, USA.

WON: By golfer **Jeev Milkha Singh**, the Bank of Austria Golf Open in Vienna, his third European Tour title. He received \$3,36,645.

WON: By **V. Ramanathan**, the Zayed Prize for Scientific/Technological Achievements in Environment in Dubai. The award was instituted by the United Arab Emirates in 1999 for global efforts to promote sustainable development at the local, regional and international levels.

VIS-A-VIS **RAJNATH SINGH** BJP president **versus** **P. CHIDAMBARAM** Union finance minister

“Chidambaram is more concerned about promotion and packaging of the Budget than the actual content of the product.”



SAURABH SINGH

“What is the record of the BJP and NDA after 1998? The average growth was only 5.8 per cent and it was abysmally low at 4.4 per cent.”

EPILOGUE: Governments blame each other, but the common man continues to suffer.